



Problems preceded Trump shooting

Exodus of veteran agents at Secret Service played role in lapses at Pa. event

BY CAROL D. LEONNIG AND EMMANUEL MARTINEZ

In the days before Donald Trump's July 13 rally in Butler, Pennsylvania, the Secret Service needed a member of his protective detail to develop a security plan to keep the former president safe as he addressed a crowd of thousands at an open-air fair-ground.

With agents stretched thin by the presidential campaign, the agency turned to a "junior" member of the detail, according to an independent review panel commissioned by the Department of Homeland Security.

In the past, the Secret Service would have trained new agents in a field office for a minimum of five years and had them work at least two more in a protective detail before assigning them to oversee such a large public event, multiple former agents told The Washington Post. The agent put in charge of security at Butler had joined the Secret Service four years earlier and only started in the protective detail in 2023, the panel found.

"If an agent with this little experience was responsible for planning Butler, that means there was nobody else," said Jonathan Wackrow, a security executive and former supervisor on then-President Barack Obama's Secret Service detail. "Now we are introducing hope as a strategy. And that is just plain dangerous."

The July 13 shooting, in which the agency's failure to block sight lines from a nearby rooftop al-

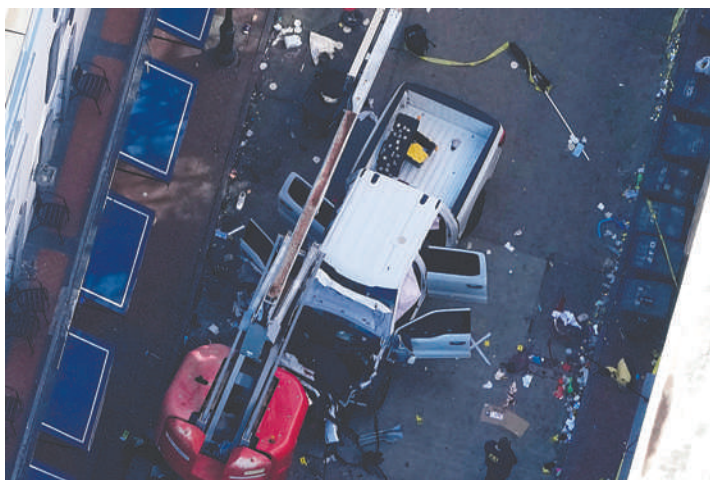
SEE SECRET SERVICE ON A4

New Orleans truck attack kills 15



MICHAEL DEMOCKER/GETTY IMAGES

Law enforcement officers work at the scene in New Orleans where a pickup truck plowed into crowds of people early Wednesday.



GERALD HERBERT/AP

An Islamic State flag and a potential explosive device were in the truck. Other apparent explosive devices were found nearby.

In moments, a Bourbon Street celebration turns into carnage

BY JESSE DOUGHERTY AND MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE

NEW ORLEANS — On New Year's Eve, in a town where anything goes, Bourbon Street sits at the center of it all. Street performers are everywhere, playing their jazz, wearing their costumes, the music blending with whatever pumps out of the nearest bar. On the balconies, locals and tourists alike drink and dance, looking down on the crowds that keep coming, that stay thick, that

seem fueled by infinite energy.

As if, no matter the hour, the fun will never end. Until suddenly, tragedy shatters the night.

"It's so, so sad, and it's so, so scary," said Matt Johnson, who was visiting from Boston and went to bed shortly before a man sped a white pickup truck onto Bourbon Street just after 3 a.m. Wednesday, ramming into revelers. At least 15 people have died, with dozens injured. The suspect was killed by police in a

SEE BOURBON STREET ON A6

MAN WITH ISIS FLAG TARGETS REVELERS

Act of terrorism leaves city horrified, mourning

BY JESSE DOUGHERTY, MARIA SACCHETTI AND MARK BERMAN

NEW ORLEANS — A man plowed a pickup truck bearing an Islamic State flag into revelers on Bourbon Street in New Orleans early Wednesday morning, killing at least 15 people and injuring many others in a grisly terrorist attack, officials said.

The FBI identified the driver as Shamsud-Din Jabbar, a 42-year-old American citizen and Army veteran born in Texas. After ramming through crowds of people who had been celebrating New Year's Eve just hours earlier, he crashed the truck and got into a shootout with responding officers, authorities said. He was pronounced dead soon after, and authorities warned that they believed others had a hand in the attack.

"We do not believe that Jabbar was solely responsible," Alethea Duncan, FBI assistant special agent in charge in New Orleans, said at a news briefing Wednesday afternoon. "We are aggressively running down every lead, including those of his known associates."

The FBI said that in addition to the Islamic State flag, they found weapons and a potential improvised explosive device in the attacker's truck, which appeared to be a rented Ford. Other explosive devices were located elsewhere in the French Quarter, the FBI said, and bomb technicians were deployed to examine all of them.

The eruption of violence marked a dreadful start to the new

SEE NEW ORLEANS ON A6

Bollards: Before attack, protective posts were removed for repair. **A7**

Game postponed: Sugar Bowl matchup rescheduled for today. **D1**

Treasury's sanctions office hacked by China, U.S. officials say

BY ELLEN NAKASHIMA AND JEFF STEIN

Chinese government hackers breached a highly sensitive office in the Treasury Department that administers economic sanctions against countries and groups of individuals — one of the most potent tools possessed by the United States to achieve national security aims, according to U.S.

Breach could intensify friction with Beijing as Trump returns to power

officials.

The targeting of the Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) as well as the Office of the Treasury

Secretary — developments not previously reported — reflects Beijing's determination to acquire intelligence on its most significant rival in the global competition for power and influence, said the officials, who like others interviewed for this report spoke on the condition of anonymity because of the matter's sensitivity.

A top area of interest for the Chinese government, current and

former officials said, would be Chinese entities that the U.S. government may be considering designating for financial sanctions.

The hack also compromised the Treasury Department's Office of Financial Research, according to the officials. The full impact of the breach, which was disclosed by Treasury in a letter to Congress on Monday, is still being assessed. The documents accessed were un-

classified and there is no evidence the hacker still has access to Treasury systems, the department said.

A spokesman for the Treasury Department declined to comment. The Chinese foreign ministry has called claims of the breach "groundless," and said that Beijing "has always opposed all forms of hacker attacks."

The breach was conducted

SEE HACK ON A9

Russian gas to Europe halted after deal expires

BY DAVID L. STERN, FRANCESCA EBEL AND CHICO HARLAN

MUKACHEVO, UKRAINE — The flow of natural gas from Russia to Europe was suspended Wednesday after Ukraine said it would not renew a deal allowing Russian gas to transit its territory, ending an energy supply route that dates back some 60 years.

In a statement posted to Telegram, Russian energy company Gazprom said it was no longer sending gas because of the expiration of the agreement Wednesday.

"Due to the repeated and explicit refusal of the Ukrainian side to extend these agreements, Gazprom was deprived of the technical and legal ability to supply gas for transit through the territory of Ukraine from January 1, 2025. Since 8:00 Moscow time, Russian gas has not been supplied for its transportation through the territory of Ukraine," it said in the statement.

Despite the ongoing Russian invasion, which has killed tens of thousands of Ukrainian soldiers

SEE UKRAINE ON A11

Memories unearthed in Y2K time capsule

A quarter-century on, Md. millennials find their artifacts — and personal bonds — are still intact

BY STEVE THOMPSON

As she descended into Maryland woods Wednesday with childhood friends, Claire Murrell couldn't remember much about what her 10-year-old self was thinking a quarter-century ago, when they buried the time capsule.

That was New Year's Eve 1999, the precipice of the new millennium, a time marker symbolizing an unknowable future. People were stocking up on gasoline and groceries, spurred by uncertainty over how telecommunications, the electrical grid, bank machines and other systems would handle

the feared (yet overblown, it turned out) Y2K bug — meaning the possible inability of computers to handle the year's new zeros.

Claire was pretty sure her 10-year-old self hadn't been worried about any of that. She remembered the huge ice cream bowls they made that night in the D.C. suburb of Silver Spring. And she dimly recalled a vision of herself in 2025: She would be married with two children, she thought back then.

The girl's prediction had not been far off. Now, as she and a group of her long-ago playmates headed toward the spot where a

SEE TIME CAPSULE ON A2



ROBB HILL FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Claire Murrell reads a letter she wrote 25 years ago and buried in a time capsule in Silver Spring.

IN THE NEWS

Purple pews As politically diverse congregations become increasingly rare, one church in suburban Los Angeles aims to endure amid increased polarization. **A3**

'Stomach bug' returns A national surge of norovirus has sickened some residents across the D.C. region in recent weeks. **B1**

THE NATION

The explosion of a Tesla Cybertruck outside the Trump Las Vegas hotel was being probed as possible terrorism. **A2**
Jimmy Carter's remains will start a 1,400-mile trek Saturday. **A7**

THE WORLD

China's leader pointed to economic ordeals and threatened Taiwan in a New Year's speech. **A8**
South Koreans mourned as all 179 victims in Sunday's Jeju Air crash were identified. **A9**

THE ECONOMY

Advisers to Donald Trump and congressional Republicans have begun floating proposals to help offset their planned tax cuts and security spending. **A10**
Elon Musk's lawsuit against rival OpenAI has gained support from two tech investors. **A10**

THE REGION

Prosecutors said a Virginia man had the largest homemade pipe-bomb stockpile ever seized by the FBI. **B1**
Denver Riggleman, a former Republican congressman, is exploring an independent bid for one of Virginia's two top offices. **B1**

STYLE

Respect would find him decades later, but as president, Jimmy Carter had a fraught relationship with the D.C. establishment. **C1**

LOCAL LIVING

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